



WEARABLES – SMARTWATCHES

Still not mainstream, smartwatches still have a long way to go

We said last year that smartwatches were a niche product, and to be very honest, they remain so, still. Companies haven't quite been able to crack what a good smartwatch will be. However, 2016 has been a step forward for sure, especially in the Indian market. More companies brought their smartwatches to India, while existing OEMs upped the ante, too.

However, unlike the smartphone market, there's not a plethora of choices out there. And if you're buying one, you're probably looking to get a feel of this ecosystem. That makes it important to only choose the smartwatches that offer a glimpse at the future. Why? Because given the lack of functionality right now, a poorly made smartwatch can completely put you off these devices.

In our book, a good smartwatch needs to be fast, support a lot of apps, and be really intuitive. Our winner and runner up this time get the closest any smartwatch has, to that perfect stage.

ZERO1 WINNER

Apple Watch Series 2

Well, Apple's uber expensive smartwatch won it last year even though it wasn't the company's best product. So, there's no reason this new, and better version shouldn't win the Zero1 Award this year. And that's not just because the new version has GPS on it.



Apple Watch Series 2

Price: ₹32,900



Samsung Gear S2

Price: ₹24,300



Pebble Time

Price: ₹8,999

To start with, the app ecosystem on Apple's Watch OS is much bigger than Android Wear or Samsung's Tizen operating systems.

The biggest improvement however, is in the fact that the Apple Watch 2 is much faster. That means it corrects its predecessor's biggest weakness. And that is what won Apple this award once again.

RUNNER UP

Samsung Gear S2

Samsung's answer to Apple's digital crown was a rotating dial. That does a lot for this smartwatch. The rotating dial makes Samsung's smartwatch unique and adds to the usability factor. In addition, it's almost as fast as Apple's device, if not even faster in some cases.

That said, Samsung's achilles heel is that the Gear S2 doesn't support a lot of apps right now. In addition, while the rotating dial is an elegant solution, it makes the Samsung Gear S2 not as sturdy as many of its competitors. We've seen slight wobbles on the dial over extended usage.

Nevertheless, the Samsung Gear S2 is a very good smartwatch and definitely a step into the future for smartwatches. It takes cues from earlier efforts by Samsung, and brings a combination of most of its best efforts onto your hand.

BEST BUY

Pebble Time

Pebble chose 2016 to enter the Indian market, and it chose an opportune time indeed. The company, in our opinion, offers some of the most value for money smartwatches in the country right now. Of course, that's no surprise, given the wide global accolades that Pebble has received for its devices.

The Pebble Time needs to be faster than it currently is, and there's definitely room for more improvement. However, the Pebble Time offers a very good package for its price tag, and all the most important apps are supported on most Pebble devices as of right now.

It's design is also unique in a way. Some say Pebble's watches look like toys, while others really love their design language. Well, looks are always subjective, but there's no denying that these are well-built smartwatches that can stand some rough usage.

The Pebble Time makes for a very good gift for you tech enthusiast friend, and it's also the perfect smartwatch to get a feel of what this kind of device can offer. And for these reasons, the Pebble Time gets the Best Buy.